



KAUST ACADEMY - Intro to Cybersecurity 2026

Kali Linux on Apple Silicon

This is a guide on how to set up Kali Linux on M2/M3/M4 MacBooks. If you come across any difficulties during the set-up, please ask for help from the TAs or feel free to message me on [LinkedIn](#).

Requirements:

1. Kali Linux - You can download it from [here](#) (choose ARM64).
2. UTM - A hypervisor to run the virtual machines. Click [here](#) to install.

Let's start to set up!

1 - Open UTM to set up the virtual machine. Follow these steps in UTM:

1. Create Virtual Machine
2. Custom: Virtualize
3. Operating System: Linux
4. Hardware: leave as is
5. Linux: boot from ISO, browse → "kali-linux-2025.4-installer-arm64.iso"
6. Storage: leave as is
7. Shared Directory: Downloads
8. Summary: set 'Name' to Kali Linux

2 - Now that we have the VM set up, we need to make a few adjustments. Let's edit the VM:

1. Edit by double-clicking the vm → Edit
2. Devices New → Serial → Save

3 - Reopen Kali Linux and use the window with "Terminal 1" in the name. Follow default installation, and when completed shut down the VM.

4 - Remove the ISO image and the recently added serial from UTM.

5 - Reopen Kali Linux.

DONE!